

Sai Krishna Vithal Lolla

(224) 730-4089 • skvlolla@gmail.com • [LinkedIn](#)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior fraud and risk strategy professional with 15+ years of experience designing and scaling enterprise fraud prevention capabilities across multiple products and business lines at major financial institutions. Proven track record of building and leading high-performing analytics teams, delivering multi-million-dollar loss reductions, and translating complex threat landscapes into scalable, customer-centric risk controls. Combines deep hands-on analytics expertise with executive influence — shaping multi-year roadmaps, governing vendor partnerships, and enabling sustainable business growth through data-driven fraud strategy.

WORK HISTORY

Lead Risk Analytics Manager | Jun 2024 – Present

USAA Federal Savings Bank

- Architect and lead enterprise-wide fraud strategy spanning onboarding, money movement, and account integrity — directly shaping the bank's fraud risk posture and influencing multi-year strategic and investment priorities.
- Conduct end-to-end assessments of organizational defenses across channels and products, delivering a comprehensive strategic roadmap to strengthen enterprise resilience against coordinated and evolving fraud attacks.
- Drive modernization of fraud detection capabilities by guiding Product and Engineering toward scalable risk-based authentication models and advanced analytics-driven controls, reducing dependence on static rules.
- Establish and govern enterprise hotlist and repeat-offender countermeasures — operationalizing institutional memory of known fraudsters to reduce systemic exposure across onboarding and transactional flows.
- Translate emerging threat intelligence, fraud trends, and external signals into actionable enterprise responses; serve as key advisor to senior leadership on risk posture and mitigation investment.
- Build and maintain cross-functional partnerships across Operations, Fraud Strategy, Technology, and vendor partners to accelerate deployment of next-generation fraud prevention capabilities.

Manager, Business Strategy | Mar 2020 – May 2024

Discover Financial Services — Riverwoods, IL

- Mentored and developed analysts and junior leaders; elevated team capability through structured problem-solving frameworks, strategic prioritization, and hands-on domain coaching — building a high-performing fraud strategy function.
- Owned enterprise authentication strategy across web, mobile, and phone channels; drove adoption of risk-based challenge models and device intelligence that reduced friction for legitimate customers while strengthening protections.
- Led cross-functional teams spanning Product, Engineering, Operations, and Cybersecurity to design and deliver integrated fraud strategies that improved anomaly detection coverage and step-up authentication effectiveness.
- Directed organization-wide risk assessments and investment recommendations; resulting fraud controls generated **\$3M+ in annual loss reduction** and measurably improved business continuity during major threat events.
- Built device fingerprinting strategy that **reduced unauthorized account access incidents by 30%**, establishing a durable identity risk management architecture across the digital ecosystem.
- Developed executive-facing KPI frameworks tracking false positive rates, step-up challenge rates, and authentication success rates — enabling evidence-based decision-making at the senior leadership level and driving resource allocation.
- Monitored key performance indicators including fraud capture rate, false positive rate, and application fallout to ensure strategy performance remained within defined risk thresholds.

Lead Credit Risk Analyst | Sep 2018 – Mar 2020

Discover Financial Services — Riverwoods, IL

Broadened enterprise risk expertise by rotating into credit risk — developing full-cycle portfolio management skills that now directly inform a holistic fraud strategy perspective spanning acquisition controls, behavioral monitoring, and loss mitigation.

- Led development of acquisition credit strategies that expanded the receivables portfolio by \$2M while maintaining controlled risk, demonstrating ability to balance growth objectives with enterprise risk appetite.
- Served as a strategic thought partner to Product and Marketing leaders, advising on credit risk standards for new customer segments and product initiatives.
- Enhanced portfolio monitoring frameworks to surface exposure spikes early, guiding executive decision-making on charge-off mitigation before losses materialized in reporting.
- Presented risk analytics and recommendations to senior leadership, influencing portfolio risk guardrails.

Lead Data Science Analyst, Fraud Strategy & Analytics | Jul 2016 – Sep 2018

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- Engineered a multi-layer 'spiderweb' application fraud strategy that combined device intelligence, account attribute linking, and behavioral transactional monitoring — achieving a **35% year-over-year reduction in application fraud losses**.
- Designed an enterprise root-cause identification framework that accelerated threat analysis and enabled more targeted, coordinated countermeasures against evolving fraud trends.
- Built organizational negative lists leveraging recycled PII and synthetic identity signals to combat application and account fraud — improving upstream identity controls and long-term portfolio health.
- Monitored key strategy performance indicators (fraud capture, false positive rate, application fallout) to ensure optimal detection coverage with minimal customer friction.
- Led department-wide forums to present evolving fraud trends and facilitate cross-functional alignment on countermeasure deployment and prioritization.

Senior Associate, Risk Management | Jun 2014 – Jun 2016

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- Supported development and validation of fraud risk strategies, building foundational expertise in strategy design, model governance, effective challenge, and regulatory adherence.
- Validated credit strategy initiatives to ensure healthy customer intake aligned with organizational risk tolerance and credit policy.
- Analyzed business strategies for robustness, internal consistency, and regulatory compliance — contributing an independent governance perspective on risk decision frameworks.
- Developed model lifecycle reporting to measure strategy and model risk across their full lifecycle, providing complete transparency to business partners and risk governance stakeholders.

EDUCATION

M.S., Management Information Systems — Oklahoma State University, Stillwater, OK (Dec 2013)

M.B.A., Finance — ICFAI University, Bangalore, India (Apr 2006)

B.S., Commerce — Andhra University, Visakhapatnam, India (Apr 2003)

CORE COMPETENCIES & TECHNICAL PROFICIENCY

Fraud Strategy: Application Fraud, Synthetic Identity, Account Takeover (ATO), Money Movement Risk, Onboarding Controls, Negative File Governance, Authentication Strategy

Analytics & Detection: Device Intelligence, Anomaly Detection, Root-Cause Analysis, Risk-Based Authentication, Behavioral Monitoring, KPI Design, False Positive Optimization

Leadership & Governance: Team Development, Executive Advisory, Cross-Functional Program Leadership, Vendor Governance, Model Lifecycle Reporting, Risk Policy Oversight

Platforms & Tools: Snowflake, SAS Suite, Tableau, Teradata, PL/SQL, Toad, MS Visio, MS Office